

The one-page AI brief for your board or CEO

A template that gets leadership aligned without a vendor pitch.

Most board AI conversations start with a vendor demo and end without a decision. A one-page brief — written by you, not by a vendor — flips the order. The board gets a picture they trust before the pitches arrive.

The five sections

- 1. What is happening today.** Two to three sentences naming the AI tools already in use across the institution and roughly how many staff use them. (You wrote this in the AI use map, if you have one.)
- 2. What our peers are doing.** One sentence with one citation. Per Bank Director's 2024 Technology Survey, 66% of community banks are discussing AI budget. Naming this neutrally — "two-thirds of our peer group is in the conversation" — sets the table without selling.
- 3. What we know we do not know.** Three to five bullets. Examples: "We do not have a written acceptable-use policy. We do not know whether staff are entering customer information into public tools. We do not have a model risk inventory."
- 4. What we are proposing for the next 90 days.** One paragraph. Examples: complete an AI use registry; establish a written acceptable-use policy aligned to SR 11-7 and TPRM guidance; pilot one internal-only use case; train every staff member on a four-term literacy primer.
- 5. What we are explicitly not doing.** Customer-facing AI. Vendor selection. Major investment. The board needs to see the boundary as clearly as the action.

Three things you can do this week

- 1. Draft the brief.** Aim for 400 words. Edit it down to 250.
- 2. Run it past one trusted peer at another community bank.** Ask if it makes sense to them. Do not ask if it is good.
- 3. Schedule it as a 15-minute item, not a presentation.** This is alignment, not a sale.

A starter prompt to draft the brief

Help me draft a one-page board brief on our community bank's AI approach for the next 90 days. The brief should have five sections: (1) what is happening today, (2) what peers are doing, (3) what we know we do not know, (4) what we are proposing, (5) what we are explicitly not doing. Keep it under 400 words. No marketing language. No "transformative" or "revolutionary." Match the tone of a credit memo.

Citations

- Bank Director 2024 Technology Survey, via Jack Henry & Associates 2025
- SR 11-7 Guidance on Model Risk Management, Federal Reserve / OCC
- Interagency Guidance on Third-Party Relationships: Risk Management, FDIC / OCC / Fed, 2023